Try-It-Out

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Part 1: Comparison and Contrast

Below is a comparison of the two sources.

Feature	**Popular Source:** ***Therapy dogs ease college life stress in students*** **(Christine Kivlen, The Conversation, 2021)**	**Academic Article:** ***Does Dogs have a Right to Seat in the Classroom? Effects of Canine Assisted Education on the Mental Health of College Students*** **(Kivlen, Quevillon, Pasquarelli; OJOT, 2022)**
Author	Christine Kivlen — PhD, professor of Occupational Therapy; The Conversation accepts contributions from a wide author pool	Three authors (Kivlen, Quevillon, Pasquarelli) — all licensed OTs with advanced degrees and university affiliations
Audience	General public / citizens interested in news and human-interest stories; no prior subject knowledge presumed	Interest groups, researchers and practitioners in Occupational Therapy; assumes professional knowledge
Purpose	To educate and entertain via storytelling; summarizes research briefly for general readers	To present new research and evidence; contributes to academic knowledge and practice
Sources cited	Few, mainly web-based references; no formal reference list	Peer-reviewed literature review and original data; full reference list (about 35 citations)
Language used	Informal, accessible (e.g., "therapy dog"); short sentences; low technicality	Formal, technical (animal-assisted intervention), academic register and specific terminology
Visuals used	Photographs of dogs and students — aesthetic and attention-grabbing	Figures and graphs (conceptual model and data charts) that document methods and results
Summary: Both sources are credible, but the academic article is more research-based and peer-reviewed and targets professionals. The popular piece simplifies findings for a general audience.		

Table 1: Comparison between the popular article and the academic article.

Part 2: Review of the Characteristics Chart of the Sources

Most rubric traits align with the comparison above. Key takeaways:

- Authorship alone does not determine whether a source is scholarly — the *context of publication*, peer review, referencing level, and purpose matter.
- Academic sources: comprehensive, organized, referenced, technical in language.
- Popular sources: concise, narrative, accessible, visually appealing.

Part 3A: Self-Assessment

Reflection on the six-question test results:

- Academic source indicators: peer review, technical language, reference list, original findings.
- Popular source indicators: simple language, shorter format, minimal references.

Part 3B: Reflection / Discussion Questions

1. What were your scores on the evaluation?

I performed better identifying the **purpose** and **audience** but found it harder to distinguish **context of authorship** and clear signs of **peer review**. This improves with practice.

2. What are the criteria by which you choose sources for a research paper?

I would combine both types:

- *Scholarly sources* for empirical evidence, theory, and rigorous citations.
- *Popular sources* for real-world examples, public perspective, and timely context.

3. What is your source of information about new research discoveries?

I typically use university news summaries, podcasts, and concise posts that interpret academic findings for broader audiences.

4. Two ways to make research more beneficial to the community

1. **Public summaries:** Authors attach plain-language summaries to journal articles to increase accessibility.
2. **Community workshops:** Universities host outreach workshops that translate research findings (e.g., therapy dog interventions) into practical community programs.